

[< Go to the original](#)



I've Written 200+ Articles With AI. Here's What I Try To Avoid.

**James Presbitero Jr.**

Follow



Write10x a11y-light ~8 min read · August 19, 2025 (Updated: August 19, 2025) · Free: No

When I first started publishing with AI, I thought I had found a shortcut.

Faster drafts. Cleaner phrasing. Ideas on demand, yada yada. But the more I published, the more I noticed something creeping in: my writing didn't sound like me anymore. It sounded like... AI.

Not just generic, but actually drained of the fingerprints that make words feel alive.

And that's terrible, because ...

Nowadays, AI writing is worse than bad writing

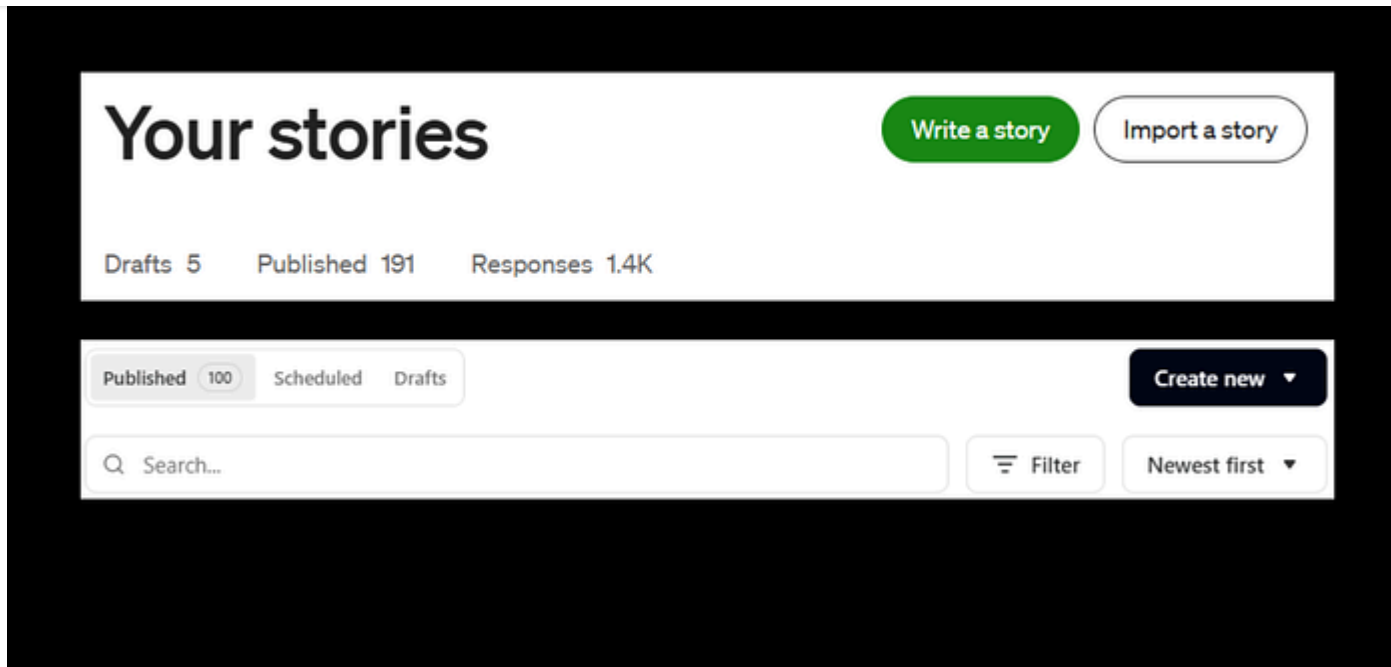
That's worse than being a "bad" writer. At least bad writing has quirks. At least it's undeniably human. When you sound "too" good, too AI, you're not just a bad

And worse: most "how to spot AI writing" articles on Medium don't help. I absolutely hate them. They recycle surface-level tricks, offer no nuance, and sometimes even use AI while claiming to detect it. I hate those with a passion, because they cheapen the conversation, and they mislead the very writers who need clarity the most.

So right here, right now, I'm drawing a line in the sand.

This article isn't for AI haters who reject the tool outright. And it's not for AI "optimizers" who chase hacks and templates.

This is for mindful writers. People who want to use AI to power up their writing, without losing themselves in the process.



I've written over 200+ articles in both Medium and Substack — not to mention, the hundred's more I've written for clients. So, I can tell you that the real work isn't prompting, but in everything outside of it. It's in the brainstorming, the planning, the editing.

For now, we're going to tackle the editing aspect. I'll write future articles about the others.

weak writing that AI has popularized. I know.

Vanilla AI produces them often, but so do humans when they get lazy. Which means this framework isn't just about editing AI outputs — it's a lens you can apply to your own writing, even if you rarely touch AI.

My editing process revolves around stripping away five indicators that show up again and again.

Remove these signs

Before we dive in, let me be clear: these aren't abstract red flags I read about in a study.

They're the exact patterns I caught infecting my own drafts — again and again — until I learned to name them and strip them out. Think of them as checkpoints. If you can spot them in your own writing, you can break them. And once you start seeing them, you'll never unsee them.

1. Overly pithy (the three-beat rhythm trap)

When used once in a while, it works. But stack them up and your essay sounds like it's trying way too hard.

This happens because AI leans into patterns. The rule of three is everywhere in human speech, so the model amplifies it. Here are examples:

- **Commands.** Three clipped imperatives in a row, e.g. *"Start now. Work hard. Never stop."*
- **Descriptors.** Three short adjectives strung together, e.g. *"Fast, simple, powerful."*
- **Statements.** Three punchy declaratives, e.g. *"You tried. You failed. You learned."*

Too much rhythm becomes robotic monotony. Readers stop hearing your voice; they hear a metronome. It drains nuance, it flattens emotion, and it makes your prose indistinguishable from every other AI-shaped essay.

My edit: break the rhythm deliberately. Stretch a sentence until it breathes. Let it wander into a story. Mix short beats with long spirals. Collapse the triplets into a single thought that hits harder because it's unexpected — because it feels alive, not automated.

from me: "Write how you think." (Partly because, you might be like me, a terrible talker.)

2. Overuse of parallels (the "not this, but that" formula)

AI loves the comfort of clean contrasts.

You've seen it: *It's not about productivity, it's about purpose.* Or *This isn't just strategy, it's survival.* At first it feels sharp, like a spotlight on truth. But stack too many and every line becomes a completely unnecessary tug-of-war.

AI does this because binary frames are easy. Black and white, all neat. Like:

- **Binary values.** *"It's not about speed, it's about quality."*
- **Reframed purpose.** *"This isn't marketing, this is storytelling."*
- **False depth.** *"It's not knowledge, it's wisdom."*

Too many parallels flatten thought. Real writing breathes in contradictions. It lives in nuance. That's what makes it human.

neatly — but sound like a real mind wrestling with reality.

3. The big reveal overload

AI defaults to the call-and-response rhythm. It feels like dialogue — but it isn't.

Once in a while, this works. Stack them up and it reads like a checklist of clichés. Q&A is safe. It fakes conversation and engagement without requiring any real voice.

Here are examples:

- **Big reveal.** *"The secret? Consistency."*
- **Instant fix.** *"The best way? Just start."*
- **False drama.** *"The problem? You're overthinking."*
- **Too much signposting:** "And here's the nuance: X"

Too much of it, and the writing loses all sense of personality. Every line becomes a gimmick.

idea or powerful moment from your life carries more weight than ten staged Q&As.

4. Weird emphasis or false specificity

AI loves to grab hold of the wrong thing and squeeze. It fixates on the irrelevant. Why? Because specificity *looks* like authority. AI assumes that if it sounds precise, it sounds persuasive.

Say for example:

- **Irrelevant object.** *"The entire day turned on the chipped blue mug beside my keyboard."*
- **Trivial timing.** *"In exactly five minutes, everything changed."*
- **Pointless detail.** *"Her shoelaces were tied in double knots — that's when I knew."*

The problem: readers sense the falseness. They know when detail is filler, not substance.

My edit: re-anchor the emphasis. Cut the false specificity. Replace it with lived details that matter — the cultural cues, emotional beats, or experience-driven

This one is a bit more difficult to spot in your own drafts, but don't worry. There are self-evaluation questions you can use. Ask yourself:

- What is the main point of this piece?
- Am I spending more words on props than the main point?
- Does this detail actually move the story or argument forward?
- Would a reader learn something about *me* or my perspective from this detail, or could it come from anyone?

If the answer tilts toward "no," it's filler. It's irrelevant, and weird. Cut it.

5. The missing fingerprints

This is the deadliest tell: words with no fingerprints. Factual, but too clean. Nobody behind them.

AI can produce sentences. It can't produce stakes. And so much of its output feels detached, as if it could have been written by anyone at all.

You've seen it: an article full of platitudes about leadership, but no story from the trenches. A list of marketing tips, but no reference to the clients, the campaigns,

And why? Because AI avoids self-reference. It has no lived story to pull from.

To be fair, it's not all bad — when properly guided, AI can surface deep context, research, and information that strengthens a draft. But in my personal belief, unless you make it personal, it will always sound hollow. Trying too hard to add information where there is no cultural or personal context still won't work.

Here are variations of it:

- **Generic platitude.** *"Leaders should inspire with vision."*
- **Universal advice.** *"Always put the customer first."*
- **Empty statement.** *"Content is king."*

Even for "faceless" brands, I don't let this slide. Every company has cultural context, customer stories, industry quirks. That's identity. Without it, content dissolves into faceless noise.

My edit: weave fingerprints back in. For myself, that means frustrations, side comments, cultural references, or analogies only I would use. For clients, I anchor the writing in their identity — lived experiences, cultural signals, brand-specific stories, even faces of their star employees.

Anything that you can add to reflect yourself, add.

AI writing, from crutch into craft

Writing with AI means shaping its power, harnessing its power of infinite iteration and instant raw output until it carries your fingerprints.

When I strip away these indicators, I end up with writing that's unmistakably human — mission-driven, story-shaped, and alive with voice. And yet, I still retain the power of AI.

Another thing:

You can absolutely write with AI *without* these indicators. Editing is strong, but so is prevention. Building or training an AI-powered assistant that avoids these habits from the start is just as powerful. That's why I created my **Authentic AI ebook**: not just to help you edit, but to help you guide AI into writing that's already closer to human from the very first draft.

That's what founders and creators need in 2025. Not to avoid AI. Not to over-optimize it. But to edit and design it into something unpromptable.

Authentic AI ebook. [You can find it on this link.](#)

(Also, if this article gets enough claps and comments, I'll know there's interest, and will launch a promotional sale)

In an algorithmic world, your best edge is still the one thing AI can't fake: you.
Learn to bring it out.

More AI writing tips, and freebies? [Subscribe to Write10x.](#)

More about AI and writing

Stop Chasing Followers. Start Building a Community.

Why community is the overlooked growth + Unpromptability engine, and the exact steps to build yours.

medium.com

medium.com

How I Built a Three-AI Newsletter System That Writes With Me, Not For Me

Learn why AI specialization beats AI generalization for authentic content creation

medium.com

Unpromptability: 5 Steps To Become Irreplaceable in the Age of AI

Don't be replaced by a guy with an LLM subscription

medium.com

Write10x is levelling up

White staying free

Freedium

ko-fi librepay patreon

#writing #ai-writing #writing-with-ai #ai #content-writing